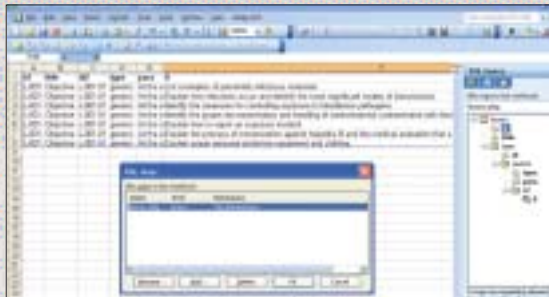


Microsoft Office Excel 2003

Excel 2003 is now able to consume and generate XML data files expressed in customer-defined XML schemas, not just the XML Spreadsheet Schema. Apart from a spreadsheet application, Excel is also an



Generate XML data files expressed in XML schemas

efficient XML editor for analysing and displaying up-to-the-second business information. Some of the new features in Excel are as follows:

Mapping tool: Excel 2003 provides a mapping tool that works much like a field chooser. With it, you can easily map existing Excel spreadsheets to XML data structures such as databases for import without writing any code.

Excel lists: You can now add structure around the data that you track in spreadsheets. The List feature provides a data entry row at the bottom of the list that automatically expands the list region as new items are entered. In addition, once data is in an Excel list, operations such as printing, charting, or creating a pivot table are made easier to perform.

Microsoft Office Access 2003

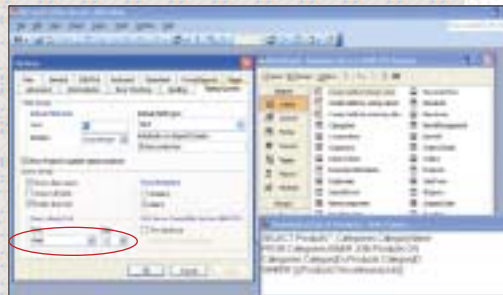
Integration with spreadsheet Web component: The new Spreadsheet Web Component feature in SharePoint Services can accept any Excel spreadsheet that is mapped to an XML schema, and provide that data to both SharePoint and non-SharePoint data sources.

Back up database: Office 2003 gives users a way to back up critical database files directly from within Access. You can now conveniently back up your important database files to a consistent location on a local system or shared network.

Access also performs a Compact and Repair action to ensure that the file is internally consistent.

Dependent objects: The new Dependent Objects feature will make it easy to determine the dependents of any object in a Jet database, reducing the debugging time needed to make a modification to an existing Access application. This feature is only available for Jet database files. There is a new 'Dependents...' command added to the shortcut menu when right-clicked on a database object. This will only be visible while right-clicking on a Table, Query, Form or Report. The 'Dependents...' command is also available in the View menu.

Font control for the SQL window: while this is not a mission-critical feature, it sure does make working with the SQL window less painful. This accessibility feature allows developers and users that create and edit Microsoft SQL Server queries



Now control the font in the SQL window

to control the font size of the text in the SQL window.

Font control can be accessed from the Tools menu, under Options, by selecting the Tables/Queries tab. There is a set of controls that allow you to set the font and size.

Make Local Table: Copying a linked table into the local database is a common technique for optimising performance for slow running reports that use linked tables or queries. In previous versions of Access, you needed to create a complex Make Table query to perform this task. Now, you can simply copy the linked table to the clipboard and paste it back into the database, or find this action in the task pane as a common task for Linked Tables.

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